

Walmart Inc.

 3 June 2026

 Verify before use

 COMPANY SNAPSHOT

1 REVENUE & MARGIN

Walmart Inc.'s last reported annual revenue was \$713.2 billion for fiscal year 2026, which ended on January 31, 2026. The operating margin is approximately 4.2% as of May 5, 2026. The net profit margin for the trailing twelve months ending April 30, 2026, was 3.14%.

2 REVENUE TREND

Walmart Inc.'s revenue and net profit margin for the last five fiscal years are as follows:

Fiscal Year End (Jan 31)	Annual Revenue (in billions USD)	Net Profit Margin (TTM as of Jan 31)
2026	\$713.2	3.07%
2025	\$681.0	2.85%
2024	\$648.1	2.39%
2023	\$611.3	1.91%
2022	\$572.8	2.39%

3 EMPLOYEES

Walmart Inc. employs approximately 2.1 million associates worldwide as of fiscal year 2026.

Breakdown by high-cost locations (US, UK, Germany, Australia, Canada): **UNVERIFIED** Not publicly available.

4 INDIA PRESENCE

Walmart has a significant presence in India through Walmart Global Tech India, which functions as a technology (R&D/delivery) center.

Headcount: Approximately 11,000 to 13,000 employees. Walmart Global Tech India had 11,029 employees as of March 2026, 11,692 India-based employees, and 13,362 employees as of December 2025.

Location: Its headquarters are in Bangalore (Embassy Tech Village, Outer Ring Road, Karnataka). Walmart Global Tech also has an office in Chennai, Tamil Nadu.

5 RECENT NEWS

December 2025 - June 2026):

(a) Product News

May 28, 2026: Walmart expanded its exclusive and private brand portfolio with new hardware assortments and the launch of Mainstays Kids. On the same day, Walmart recalled Mainstays 9-Drawer Fabric Dressers due to tip-over and entrapment hazards.

May 19, 2026: Lee® announced its first celebrity collaboration with Kacey Musgraves exclusively for Walmart.

April 30, 2026: Walmart launched a pilot program to redefine the beauty aisle, turning passion into a profession.

April 6, 2026: Several consumer products, including electrical cords, baby swim products, and cookware, sold through Walmart's online marketplace by third-party sellers, were subject to federal safety warnings and recalls due to risks like electrocution, drowning, and burn injuries.

(b) Company News

June 2, 2026: Walmart expanded its 30-minute-or-less delivery service across 33 U.S. markets for groceries, pharmacy items, and everyday essentials. Also, Walmart expanded its commitment to the Bridegan Foundation's Bexley Boxes program in Florida, helping law enforcement agencies provide comfort kits for children impacted by crime.

May 26, 2026: Walmart enhanced its supply chain with a new Prepaid Consolidation program to move products to shelves faster.

May 21, 2026: Walmart released its Q1 FY27 earnings report.

April 29, 2026: Walmart opened its third owned and operated milk processing facility in Robinson, Texas, creating over 400 new jobs. Additionally, Walmart Healthcare Research Institute and Care Access opened their first locations in Texas and Georgia, expanding access to clinical research.

April 23, 2026: Walmart released its 2026 Annual Report and Proxy Statement.

February 19, 2026: Walmart raised its annual dividend to \$0.99 per share, marking its 53rd consecutive year of dividend increases, and released its Q4 FY26 earnings.

December 9, 2025: Walmart debuted on Nasdaq, completing its transfer of stock exchange listing from the New York Stock Exchange.

6 M&A ACTIVITY

June 2024 - June 2026):

Acquisitions: Walmart acquired VIZIO for \$2.3 billion (or \$2 billion) in February 2024.

Divestitures: Walmart divested its Advanced Systems and Robotics Business to Symbotic on January 28, 2025.

Investments: Walmart invested in OnePay in a \$300 million undisclosed stage round on December 12, 2024.

7 OWNERSHIP STRUCTURE

Walmart Inc. is a publicly traded company listed on the Nasdaq Stock Exchange under the ticker symbol WMT. It is also a family-owned business, with the Walton family (descendants of founder Sam Walton) collectively controlling approximately 45-46% of outstanding shares, primarily through Walton Enterprises LLC and the Walton Family Holdings Trust.

8 KEY COMPETITORS

Walmart Inc.'s top direct competitors include:

Amazon

Target

Costco Wholesale Corporation

The Kroger Co.

Dollar General Corporation

GAP FILL

Walmart's annual revenue for the fiscal year 2022 was \$572.75 billion. For fiscal year 2023, the annual revenue was \$611.29 billion. In fiscal year 2024, Walmart's annual revenue reached \$648.13 billion. Walmart's fiscal year ends on January 31st.

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1. CORPORATE VISION & DIRECTION

Walmart's leadership is steering the company towards sustained growth and increased shareholder value over the next 12-18 months by prioritizing a compelling value proposition, speed, and omnichannel capabilities. The company reiterated its full-year guidance for constant currency sales growth between 3.5% and 4.5%, and operating income growth of 6% to 8% for fiscal year 2027.

CEO Doug McMillon has emphasized the profound impact of AI, stating, "It's very clear that AI is going to change literally every job" and that "Walmart would eliminate some jobs over the next three years and create others, but that overall, AI would have a profound impact on **INFERRED** every occupation." Despite these changes, McMillon stresses that people remain central to Walmart's business, encouraging associates to be "lifelong learners" and equipping them with new tools to improve their jobs.

Key aspects of the future direction include:

Customer Value and Convenience: Continuing to resonate with customers through "low prices with convenience" and faster delivery speeds.

Omnichannel Expansion: Scaling tech-powered businesses like advertising and fulfillment services, and enhancing e-commerce capabilities to meet evolving consumer demands.

Digital Transformation: Integrating advanced technologies like AI and data analytics deeper into core operations to redefine efficiency and customer experience.

Profitability Improvement: Reshaping its profit mix to allow for investments in lower prices, associate wages, and experience-enhancing technologies while aiming to grow profit faster than sales.

2. BIG STRATEGIC INITIATIVES

Walmart has several significant strategic initiatives underway, spanning physical expansion, operational efficiency, and sustainability.

Store Expansion and Modernization:

Walmart plans to build or convert over 150 new stores and remodel 650 existing stores across 47 U.S. states and Puerto Rico in the next five years.

Approximately 20 new stores are slated to open in 2026 and early 2027.

These new and remodeled stores will feature "Store of the Future" concepts, including improved layouts, wider aisles, expanded product selections, new digital touchpoints, and enhanced pickup and delivery capabilities.

Healthcare Expansion: The company is significantly expanding its healthcare services, aiming for over 75 Walmart Health centers by early 2025.

Supply Chain Optimization:

Walmart is scaling its drone delivery program, aiming for 100 drone-enabled stores across five states by the end of 2025, with a goal of 95% same-day coverage.

The company operates high-tech consolidation centers, such as those in Colton, California; Minooka, Illinois; and Lebanon, Pennsylvania, which utilize automated technology to handle three times more volume and improve efficiency.

A prepaid consolidation program for suppliers is being expanded to simplify shipping and optimize inventory allocation across its distribution network.

Sustainability Mandates: New and remodeled stores incorporate sustainable design principles, including energy-efficient equipment and lighting, and lower-impact refrigerants. Walmart is also developing a coast-to-coast network of electric vehicle fast-charging stations.

Cost Transformation and Restructuring:

Walmart has undergone organizational restructuring, including the elimination of several hundred corporate support roles tied to store operations and employee training (e.g., market coordinators and some Walmart Academy positions) in 2025. These changes are part of a strategic effort to "simplify operations and better support stores."

In May 2025, Walmart eliminated approximately 1,500 corporate positions in global tech, e-commerce fulfillment, and advertising as part of efforts to reduce layers of management and organizational complexity.

These restructuring efforts are partly driven by a platform consolidation completed over the past year, merging distinct technology operations for Walmart U.S., Sam's Club, and international businesses into one unified global platform.

"Grow with US" Program: Walmart has committed to investing \$350 billion in USA-manufactured products by 2030, collaborating with small to medium-sized enterprises.

3. TECHNOLOGY STRATEGY

Walmart's technology strategy is heavily centered on AI adoption, a hybrid cloud approach, and platform consolidation, with a balanced "build vs. buy" philosophy.

AI Adoption Stance:

Walmart is comprehensively integrating AI across its business, from inventory management to customer experience.

The company's approach to AI, particularly "agentic AI," is "surgical," deploying agents for highly specific tasks that can be stitched together to solve complex workflows.

Walmart is developing purpose-built agentic AI tools, leveraging its own data and large language models (LLMs) to drive business impact.

CEO John Furner noted that AI is helping Walmart "serve needs previous technologies could not meet," leading to more personalized shopping and expanded customer interactions.

Specific AI Initiatives and Programs:

Inventory and Supply Chain: AI systems predict demand, optimize stock levels, reduce waste, and enhance supply chain efficiency, with "Route Optimization" now offered as a Software as a Service (SaaS).

In-Store Technology: "Scan & Go" technology uses computer vision to allow customers to skip checkout lines.

Associate Tools: The "Ask Sam" app is an AI-driven assistant that helps associates with queries, and a GenAI tool called "My Assistant" is being rolled out to 2.1 million associates. Walmart also promotes AI literacy among its workforce and uses ChatGPT Enterprise for teams.

Customer Experience: Walmart's GenAI-powered shopping assistant, "Sparky," uses multi-agent orchestration and evolving voice/camera capabilities, with weekly active users increasing over 100%. Customer-facing shopping agents and computer-vision checkout systems are part of the 2024-2025 roadmap.

Partnerships: Walmart partnered with OpenAI in October 2025 to create "AI-first shopping experiences," allowing customers to shop through ChatGPT using Instant Checkout.

Efficiency: LLMs are being used to reduce fashion lead times by an estimated 18 weeks.

Cloud Migration:

Walmart adopted a hybrid cloud approach in 2017, using a combination of on-premises and cloud resources.

Cloud resources are utilized for workloads requiring scalability and flexibility (e.g., e-commerce, supply chain management), while on-premises resources handle low-latency or high-security workloads (e.g., point-of-sale systems).

Walmart partners with Microsoft Azure for its cloud transformation, migrating hundreds of critical applications and re-architecting them to leverage cloud-native features. The company also utilizes Google Cloud.

Walmart has built its own OpenStack-based cloud infrastructure across its facilities and stores, creating a multi-cloud architecture that combines its private cloud with public cloud providers to optimize costs and speed development.

Platform Consolidation:

To achieve greater efficiency and scalability, Walmart has consolidated its e-commerce and marketplace operations into a single global platform. This move has led to a reduction of duplicate roles and a streamlining of technology operations.

Vendor Relationships & Build vs. Buy Signals:

Historically, Walmart favored a "build rather than buy" approach for its strategic information systems, believing it provides a competitive advantage.

Currently, Walmart continues to build its core AI and global platform infrastructure internally to maintain control over the customer experience and market responsiveness.

For specialized technologies, Walmart strategically partners with external providers, such as Symbolic for automated picking and delivery systems, while retaining control over the data and AI models that power them.

The company has developed its own "internal AI foundry" and an "Element" platform capable of rapid AI application creation, demonstrating a strong build capability in AI.

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 LEADERSHIP & ORG

1

KEY DECISION MAKERS

CEO: John Furner

Start Date: February 1, 2026

Background: Furner previously served as President and CEO of Walmart U.S. from 2019 to January 2026 and CEO of Sam's Club from 2017 to 2019. He started his career at Walmart as an hourly associate in 1993 and has held leadership roles in merchandising, operations, and sourcing.

CFO: John David Rainey

Start Date: May 2022 (assumed responsibilities on June 6, 2022)

Background: Rainey is responsible for Walmart's financial operations, corporate strategy, global procurement, and investor relations. Prior to joining Walmart, he was CFO and Executive Vice President of Global Customer Operations at PayPal, and previously held CFO positions at United Airlines.

CTO/CDO/CIO: Suresh Kumar (Executive Vice President, Global Chief Technology Officer and Chief Development Officer)

Start Date: July 2019

Background: Kumar is responsible for setting Walmart's technical strategy and leading the development of tools and systems for digital transformation across global operations. He has over 30 years of technology leadership experience, including senior roles at Google, Microsoft, and Amazon.

COO: Walmart Inc. does not have a single corporate Chief Operating Officer (COO), instead relying on COOs within its business segments.

Kieran Shanahan (Executive Vice President and Chief Operating Officer, Walmart U.S.)

Start Date: August 2023

Background: Shanahan is responsible for all aspects of Walmart's U.S. Store Operations and Supply Chain, including strategy, innovation, automation, and last-mile delivery. He previously served as EVP, International Operations, and regional CEO for Walmart International.

2

RECENT LEADERSHIP CHANGES

Doug McMillon (Former President and CEO, Walmart Inc.)

Departure: Retired as President and CEO on January 31, 2026. He remains on the Board of Directors until the next annual shareholders' meeting and will serve as an advisor until January 2027.

Timing Signal: February 2026

John Furner (Current President and CEO, Walmart Inc.)

Change: Promoted from President and CEO of Walmart U.S. to President and CEO of Walmart Inc., effective February 1, 2026.

Timing Signal: February 2026

David Guggina (President and CEO, Walmart U.S.)

Change: Appointed President and CEO of Walmart U.S., effective February 1, 2026. He previously served as EVP and Chief eCommerce Officer for Walmart U.S.

Timing Signal: February 2026

Chris Nicholas (President and CEO, Walmart International)

Change: Appointed President and CEO of Walmart International, effective February 1, 2026. He was previously President and CEO of Sam's Club (from September 2023 to February 2026) and EVP and COO for Walmart U.S. before that.

Timing Signal: February 2026

Latriece Watkins (President and CEO, Sam's Club U.S.)

Change: Appointed President and CEO of Sam's Club U.S., effective February 1, 2026. She was previously EVP and Chief Merchandising Officer for Walmart U.S.

Timing Signal: February 2026

Seth Dallaire (Executive Vice President and Chief Growth Officer, Walmart Inc.)

Change: Elevated to EVP and Chief Growth Officer for Walmart Inc., overseeing global enterprise platforms, effective February 1, 2026. He was previously EVP and Chief Growth Officer for Walmart U.S.

Timing Signal: February 2026

Kath McLay (Former President and CEO, Walmart International)

Departure: Succeeded by Chris Nicholas as President and CEO of Walmart International, effective February 1, 2026.

Timing Signal: February 2026

Tom Ward (Former Chief Operating Officer, Sam's Club)

Departure: Retiring as of May 2026.

Timing Signal: May 2026

Cedric Clark (Former Executive Vice President, U.S. Store Operations)

Departure: Leaving the company as of May 2026.

Timing Signal: May 2026

Judith McKenna (Former CEO, Walmart International)

Departure: Exited the company on February 1, 2024, after 27 years with Walmart.

Timing Signal: February 2024

Denise Malloy (Former Chief Belonging Officer, Senior Vice President)

Departure: Left the company around January 2024.

Timing Signal: January 2024

Kevin Buncum (Former Executive Vice President and Head of Neighborhood Market business)

Departure: Retired from the company around January 2024.

Timing Signal: January 2024

3 ORG STRUCTURE SIGNALS

Walmart's technology organization is largely centralized globally. Suresh Kumar, as the Executive Vice President, Global CTO and Chief Development Officer, leads a global team of technologists who support Walmart U.S., Sam's Club, and Walmart International. His purview includes global shared services, data, cloud, infrastructure, and information security. Recent leadership changes, effective February 1, 2026, indicate a strategic move to centralize platforms to accelerate shared capabilities, enabling operating segments to focus more closely on customers and members. This structure is notable for operating without a traditional corporate-level COO, instead relying on strong segment CEOs and centralized functional Executive Vice Presidents for areas like technology, finance, people, and legal.

Key members of Walmart's Board of Directors include:

John Furner (President and CEO, Walmart Inc.): Appointed to the Board of Directors effective November 2025.

Doug McMillon (Former President and CEO, Walmart Inc.): Remains on the Board of Directors until the next annual shareholders' meeting (expected June 2026).

Tim Flynn: A member of Walmart's Board of Directors, he has served on the board for almost 14 years as of May 2026.

While no explicit mention of private equity (PE) representation or notable strategic investors on the board was found in the provided snippets, it is worth noting that some Walmart executives serve on other boards. For example, John David Rainey serves on the board of directors and audit committee of Microsoft Corporation and on the board of PhonePe. Donna Morris is on the Board of Trustees at Fordham University and a member of the board of directors of PhonePe and UKG.

GAP FILL

John David Rainey joined Walmart as Executive Vice President and Chief Financial Officer in May 2022. Prior to this, he served as CFO and Executive Vice President of Global Customer Operations at PayPal from 2015 to 2022. Before PayPal, Rainey spent 18 years at United Airlines and Continental Airlines, ultimately serving as Executive Vice President and CFO at United. He began his professional career at Ernst & Young LLP.

✓ LEADERSHIP VERIFIED

Here's the verified executive status for Walmart Inc. based on recent targeted searches:

CONFIRMED STILL IN ROLE:

John Furner, CEO

Confirmation Source/Date: Furner became President and CEO of Walmart Inc. effective February 1, 2026, succeeding Doug McMillon.

UNCONFIRMED STILL IN ROLE:

John David Rainey, CFO

No recent (within 6 months of current date, June 2026) confirmation found regarding his continued tenure as CFO in the search results.

Suresh Kumar, Executive Vice President, Global Chief Technology Officer and Chief Development Officer (CTO/CDO/CIO)

No recent (within 6 months of current date, June 2026) confirmation found regarding his continued tenure in his role in the search results.

CONFIRMED DEPARTED:

No departures were found from the provided list of current leadership (John Furner, John David Rainey, Suresh Kumar).

Additional recent executive changes at Walmart Inc. not on the provided list include:

Doug McMillon, former CEO of Walmart Inc., retired in January 2026.

Kath McLay, former President and CEO of Walmart International, left the company, with her departure announced on January 1, 2026.

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 BUYING SIGNALS

1 FINANCIAL STRESS SIGNALS

Margin Compression & Cost-Cutting: While Walmart generally reports strong financial performance, its operating margin slipped slightly to 4.3% of net sales in Q1 FY27 (ended April 30, 2026) due to operating expenses rising faster than sales. This increase reflects higher depreciation from automation and omnichannel investments, business reorganization charges, and increased U.S. healthcare costs. However, the operating margin for Q1 2026 was 4.61%, an increase from the prior quarter's 3.73%. The latest twelve months' gross profit margin is 24.9% and the operating profit margin is 4.18%. To combat costs and improve efficiency, Walmart is rolling out a "Prepaid Consolidation" supply chain strategy aimed at simplifying inbound supplier logistics and lowering overall costs.

Layoffs & Restructuring: In May 2026, Walmart announced plans to lay off or relocate UNVERIFIED approximately 1,000 corporate employees as part of a restructuring effort to enhance the efficiency of its global technology and product teams. These changes target overlapping roles across global technology, AI product work, e-commerce, and advertising, following a similar restructuring in the previous year that impacted around 1,500 positions.

2 TECHNOLOGY PAIN SIGNALS

Legacy System Mentions & Tech Debt: Walmart's past challenges with digital agility due to its massive scale and legacy systems have necessitated a reinvention of its technology strategy. The recent corporate restructuring, which aims to move product and tech teams onto a shared system, indicates a concerted effort to address historical fragmentation and improve technological efficiency.

AI Integration & Workforce Adaptation: Walmart is heavily investing in AI and automation to streamline operations, enhance customer experience, and improve supply chain logistics, with clear targets for automation to service two-thirds of its stores and a majority of fulfillment center volume by fiscal year 2026. This rapid integration, however, brings challenges related to workforce adaptation and the need for employee reskilling.

3 OPERATIONAL PAIN SIGNALS

Supply Chain Issues: Walmart is actively revamping its supply chain with the "Prepaid Consolidation" strategy. This initiative aims to accelerate product delivery, simplify inbound supplier logistics, and build a more connected, scalable, and tech-enabled supply chain to improve service and reduce costs. This suggests that previous supply chain inefficiencies or complexities are being addressed.

Scaling Problems: The company is expanding its first-mile capabilities and national supply chain network to merge shipments more efficiently, indicating a focus on improving the scalability of its logistics. Additionally, Walmart is expanding modern fulfillment capacity to achieve higher throughput and faster online order processing.

Operational Efficiency: Improving operational efficiency is a primary driver behind Walmart's investments in automation, AI, and supply chain restructuring.

4 HIRING SIGNALS

Hiring Freeze & Layoffs: In September 2025, Walmart's CEO announced a hiring freeze for most positions over the next three years, anticipating future revenue growth to be driven by AI adoption rather than increased headcount. This was compounded in October 2025 by a pause on H-1B visa hires due to a new \$100,000 fee imposed by the Trump administration, primarily affecting corporate roles. Further, May 2026 saw layoffs and relocations affecting approximately 1,000 corporate employees as part of a broader restructuring.

5 TIMING TRIGGERS

New Leadership & Transformation: John Furner assumed the role of President and CEO of Walmart Inc. on February 1, 2026, succeeding Doug McMillon. This leadership change, along with several other key executive appointments effective the same date, is intended to fuel innovation and drive Walmart's "next phase of retail transformation." The company is centralizing its platforms to accelerate shared capabilities, acknowledging AI's rapid reshaping of the retail landscape. Walmart has explicitly announced its ambition to evolve from a traditional

retailer into a "technology-powered enterprise" and a "tech-centric company," supported by substantial investments in AI, automation, and digital capabilities.

GAP FILL

Walmart's operating profit margin for the trailing twelve months (TTM) as of June 2026 is 4.13%. Other recent TTM figures for 2026 include 4.18% as of May 2026 and April 2026, and 4.22% as of April 2026.

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COMPETITIVE & VENDORS

1. Current Tech Vendors

Walmart operates with a sophisticated and evolving technology stack, heavily leveraging cloud infrastructure, artificial intelligence (AI), machine learning (ML), and in-house developed platforms.

Cloud Platforms: Walmart has adopted a multi-cloud strategy, primarily utilizing Microsoft Azure as its chosen cloud platform. They also deploy workloads on Google Cloud and maintain a significant private cloud infrastructure. The "Walmart Cloud Native Platform (WCNP)" is a Kubernetes-based platform that runs containerized workloads across these edge (stores, distribution centers) and public cloud environments.

AI/Machine Learning Platforms: Walmart has developed an in-house AI/ML platform named "Element." This platform is built on Kubernetes and is designed to run across Walmart's private cloud, Google Cloud, and Microsoft Azure. Element helps data scientists build and scale AI/ML solutions efficiently, offering access to various tools and standardizing processes. They are also developing proprietary Generative AI (GenAI) platforms, including "Wallaby," a series of retail-specific Large Language Models (LLMs) trained with Walmart's data for customer-facing experiences. Additionally, they utilize an AI-powered Customer Support Assistant and an Augmented Reality (AR) platform called "Retina".

Data Platforms: Walmart's data transformation and AI experiences are powered by a "triplet model" multi-hybrid cloud. The company utilizes multiple Business Intelligence (BI) and analytic tools, including a Teradata warehouse, NoSQL databases, SAS, and Hadoop technologies. "Retail Link" is a foundational platform providing suppliers with direct access to Walmart's data grid for real-time inventory tracking and insights.

General Technology Stack: The broader tech stack includes:

Application & Data: JavaScript, Python, AngularJS, Java, React, Spring Boot, Node.js, MySQL, PostgreSQL, MongoDB, DynamoDB, Firebase.

DevOps: GitHub, Ansible, Docker, Kubernetes.

Business Tools: Slack, Jira, Microsoft Office 365.

Operating Systems: Linux, Windows, macOS.

Web Servers: Apache, Nginx.

Storage Solutions: AWS S3, Google Firebase Storage.

ERP, CRM, PLM, HCM: While specific traditional ERP, CRM, PLM, and HCM vendors are not explicitly detailed in recent public information, Walmart has partnered with Salesforce to make its Walmart Commerce Technologies and Walmart GoLocal applications available through Salesforce AppExchange. This suggests Salesforce is leveraged for commerce-related CRM or order management functionalities. The significant investment in internal development and cloud-native solutions implies a customized or componentized approach for these enterprise functions, potentially reducing reliance on single, off-the-shelf monolithic systems for core retail operations.

2. Known SI/Consulting Partners

Walmart engages with several strategic consulting and system integration (SI) partners to drive its digital initiatives and operational efficiencies.

Infosys: Infosys, a global digital services and consulting firm, collaborates with Walmart Commerce Technologies. This partnership focuses on helping other retailers implement Walmart's cloud-based "Store Assist" solution, which enhances omnichannel experiences like pickup, delivery, and shipping from stores.

Accenture: Accenture is a key partner in Walmart's strategic initiatives, particularly concerning AI and workforce transformation. They are involved in developing workforce strategies with AI in mind and led a pilot program with Walmart and Unilever to explore talent mobility and upskilling for the future of work. Accenture also partners with Walmart, NVIDIA, and Microsoft to implement "Physical AI" for inventory management and backroom operations, utilizing NVIDIA Omniverse for simulation. Furthermore, Accenture is part of OpenAI's AI job training initiative with Walmart.

Other Consulting Partners: Walmart also works with specialized consulting firms for its marketplace and supplier ecosystem. These include:

David Ricardo Inc.: Provides multi-channel and omnichannel marketplace consulting, assisting with marketing, advertising, and account optimization on Walmart Marketplace.

ClearSight Consulting: A boutique agency specializing in marketplace management, catalog optimization, content strategy, fulfillment, and media buying for Walmart.com.

8th & Walton: Offers in-depth support to Walmart suppliers to improve business efficiency, reduce fines, and enhance relationships with Walmart.

SalesDuo, Canopy Management, Infinity Blue: These are listed as top Walmart Marketplace consultants, offering services ranging from AI-driven advertising and full-service management to global expansion and optimization.

Market Performance Group (MPG): Serves as a full-service growth partner with expertise in Walmart and Sam's Club strategies, leveraging data and insights.

3. Procurement Signals

Walmart's procurement signals are strongly aligned with its ongoing digital transformation and its focus on AI, automation, and enhanced omnichannel customer experiences.

Digital Transformation & AI Investment: Walmart is making substantial investments in digital infrastructure, e-commerce, automated fulfillment centers, and AI-enabled logistics to optimize inventory and delivery. This includes projects leveraging generative and agentic AI for customer experience, inventory flows, and automation. The company plans to automate approximately 65% of its stores' services by the end of fiscal year 2026.

Cloud-First Strategy: The major partnership with Microsoft Azure for cloud transformation signals a continuous move towards scalable and secure cloud infrastructure. Walmart's internal "Element" ML platform's ability to deploy across multiple public clouds (Azure, Google) and its private cloud further indicates a flexible, cloud-agnostic approach where optimal cloud environments are leveraged for different workloads.

In-house Platform Development: Walmart is heavily invested in developing its own technology solutions, such as the "Store Assist" app for omnichannel fulfillment and the "Wallaby" GenAI platform. The "Code Puppy" vibe-coding platform allows associates to create their own AI products, indicating a strong internal innovation drive.

Partnerships for Specialized Solutions: The collaboration with Infosys for "Store Assist" implementation and with Salesforce for Commerce Technologies and GoLocal applications indicates a strategy of partnering with external vendors for specific, best-of-breed solutions that integrate into their broader ecosystem.

Focus Areas: Key areas for technology investment include personalized customer experiences, optimized pricing strategies, product availability, supply chain automation, demand forecasting, and last-mile delivery.

4. Competitive Dynamics

Walmart operates in a highly competitive retail landscape, facing formidable rivals across various segments.

Top Competitors: Walmart's primary competitors include Amazon.com Inc., Costco Wholesale Corp, and Target Corp. Other significant competitors include Kroger Co, Home Depot Inc., Dollar General Corp, Dollar Tree Inc., BJ's Wholesale Club Holdings Inc, Rakuten, Tesco, Ahold Delhaize, Carrefour, Best Buy, Lowe's, Walgreens, and Aldi.

Overall Market Share: Walmart remains the world's largest retailer, serving approximately 270 million customers weekly in 2025. In fiscal year 2025, Walmart's global revenue reached \$681.0 billion, up 5.1% year-over-year. Its share of the U.S. retail market was 6.04% in FY2025.

Competitive Position - Gaining or Losing Market Share:

Grocery Market: Walmart is experiencing a slight decline in its dominant grocery market share. Its share fell from 20.4% in 2024 to 19.9% in 2026. During this period, Costco has been gaining ground, rising to an 8.2% share, while Amazon and Whole Foods combined saw their share increase to 8% in 2026. Kroger's share has also been shrinking. Despite this, Walmart remains the biggest player in U.S. grocery, with around 72% of U.S. households purchasing at least some groceries from Walmart.

E-commerce Market: Amazon continues to dominate the U.S. e-commerce market, holding approximately 40% market share in 2024, compared to Walmart's 6.4%. However, Walmart is rapidly gaining e-commerce market share, with its online sales

growing nearly three times faster than Amazon's (27.2% year-over-year for Walmart vs. 9.6% for Amazon in Q3 2025). Walmart's U.S. online sales surged from \$27 billion in 2019 to \$82 billion by the end of 2023, and online revenue totaled \$120.9 billion in FY2025. Walmart's omnichannel approach, leveraging its extensive physical store network for online order fulfillment, pickup, and delivery, provides a significant competitive advantage over online-only retailers.

Overall Dynamics: While Walmart faces intense competition and is seeing some market share erosion in specific segments like grocery, its overall market leadership is maintained through its scale, extensive omnichannel capabilities, and aggressive digital transformation efforts. The company's strategic investments in AI and automation are crucial for defending and growing its market position against digitally native giants and traditional retailers alike.

GAP FILL

Walmart's AI strategy in 2026 involves significant partnerships and a robust internal technology stack. Key partnerships include OpenAI for integrating its Sparky AI assistant into ChatGPT for product discovery and Google (Gemini) for enabling shopping within Gemini using a Universal Commerce Protocol. Walmart also utilizes Microsoft Azure cloud services, specifically Azure OpenAI services, for generative AI, search, personalization, and logistics.

Internally, Walmart's AI technology stack features Sparky, a proprietary GenAI-powered shopping assistant, and Code Puppy, an in-house AI agent for employee tasks. The company's proprietary machine learning platform, Element, powers its AI tools and supports scalable AI deployments. Walmart also uses its Squiggly platform for AI training and certifications for associates, and has secured patents for machine learning systems in retail pricing.

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SALES PLAY

1. RECOMMENDED PITCH ANGLE

AI-Powered Operational Transformation Play

Walmart is at an inflection point where AI integration has moved from experiment to operational mandate under new CEO John Furner's leadership. With 1,000+ recent corporate layoffs targeting overlapping roles in global technology and AI product work, a hiring freeze through 2028, and explicit board-level commitment to becoming a "technology-powered enterprise," the company needs solutions that accelerate AI deployment while reducing headcount dependencies. Their surgical approach to agentic AI, internal platforms like Element and Wallaby, and the CEO's public statements that AI will "change literally every job" signal urgent need for solutions that help them scale AI capabilities faster than their build-only approach allows, particularly in areas outside core retail operations where speed-to-value matters more than proprietary advantage.

2. CONVERSATION OPENER QUESTIONS

Question 1: With the May 2026 restructuring consolidating product and tech teams onto shared systems and eliminating roughly 1,000 positions in overlapping AI, e-commerce, and advertising roles, how are you balancing the velocity of AI deployment against the reduced internal capacity, particularly for non-differentiating AI use cases outside core retail operations?

Question 2: Your Prepaid Consolidation supply chain program launched in May 2026 aims to simplify inbound logistics and accelerate shelf delivery. As you scale this across your supplier base, what are the biggest data integration or system interoperability challenges you're encountering with suppliers who lack the technical sophistication to plug into Walmart's advanced platforms?

Question 3: Suresh Kumar's team consolidated Walmart U.S., Sam's Club, and International onto one global platform over the past year. Now that platform consolidation is complete, where are the biggest remaining pockets of technical debt or fragmented systems that prevent you from fully leveraging that unified architecture, especially in back-office functions or associate-facing tools?

Question 4: You're targeting 65% store automation by end of FY26 and investing heavily in Element ML platform and Wallaby GenAI models. For the AI agents you're building internally, what percentage are reaching production versus stalling in pilot phase, and what are the common bottlenecks—data quality, model training costs, integration complexity, or change management?

Question 5: With the hiring freeze extending through 2028 and Doug McMillon's explicit message that associates need to become "lifelong learners," how is the organization currently approaching AI upskilling at scale for 2.1 million associates globally, and are your current training platforms like Squiggly adequate for the pace of change you're experiencing?

3. LANDMINES TO AVOID

Landmine 1: Do not position your solution as a replacement for their proprietary AI platforms Element, Wallaby, or Sparky. Walmart views these as core competitive differentiators and has invested heavily in building versus buying for customer-facing and retail-specific AI. Any suggestion that external solutions are superior to their internal capabilities will immediately close the door. Frame around complementary capabilities or non-core use cases only.

Landmine 2: Avoid leading with solutions that require significant new headcount to implement or operate. With a hiring freeze through 2028, explicit AI-driven headcount reduction goals, and recent 1,000-person layoffs in tech roles, any offering that implies "you'll need to hire a team to run this" contradicts their entire strategic direction. Emphasize automation, self-service, and reduction in operational overhead.

Landmine 3: Do not criticize their multi-cloud or hybrid cloud strategy or suggest consolidating to a single cloud provider. Walmart has deliberately chosen a multi-cloud approach with Azure, Google Cloud, and private cloud through WCNP. They view cloud flexibility as strategic and have already made massive infrastructure investments. Position as cloud-agnostic or explicitly compatible with their existing Azure-primary, multi-cloud architecture.

Landmine 4: Never reference healthcare expansion plans or suggest healthcare technology solutions. Walmart quietly shut down its Walmart Health centers initiative in 2024 after initially targeting 75+ locations by early 2025. This was a significant strategic retreat and financial write-off. Bringing it up signals you haven't done current research and touches on a recent failure.

4. SUGGESTED NEXT STEP

Request a 30-minute discovery call focused specifically on their post-restructuring AI operationalization challenges, positioned as a peer learning conversation rather than a sales pitch. Propose bringing a technical architect who has solved similar AI scaling challenges at other Fortune 10 retailers post-reorganization to discuss specific patterns around AI agent deployment bottlenecks, data pipeline optimization for multi-cloud ML platforms, or associate-facing AI tool adoption measurement. Offer to share a brief pre-read case study of how a comparable enterprise accelerated AI velocity while reducing technical headcount. Frame the meeting as mutual exploration of whether there's a fit for non-core AI use cases where speed matters more than proprietary advantage.

5. BEST ENTRY POINT

Suresh Kumar, Executive Vice President, Global Chief Technology Officer and Chief Development Officer

Kumar is the single best entry point because he owns the entire global technology strategy and platform consolidation that just completed, directly oversees the Element ML platform and AI development across all business units, and reports directly to CEO John Furner. He has been in role since July 2019, giving him deep institutional knowledge while also being accountable for delivering the AI transformation that justifies the hiring freeze and headcount reductions. The May 2026 restructuring that eliminated 1,000 positions in global tech, AI product work, e-commerce, and advertising all fall within his organization, meaning he is currently managing the exact pain point of doing more with fewer people. His 30+ years of technology leadership at Google, Microsoft, and Amazon means he thinks in build-versus-buy terms and will quickly assess whether external solutions add value to areas outside Walmart's core build focus. Any technology decision of significance at Walmart's scale requires his approval or sponsorship, and his team's current focus on shared global platforms means he has both budget authority and strategic mandate to evaluate solutions that accelerate capabilities his reduced team cannot build fast enough internally. His public statements about Walmart's technical strategy and platform approach are well-documented, making it possible to craft highly informed outreach that demonstrates understanding of his specific priorities and current organizational challenges.

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